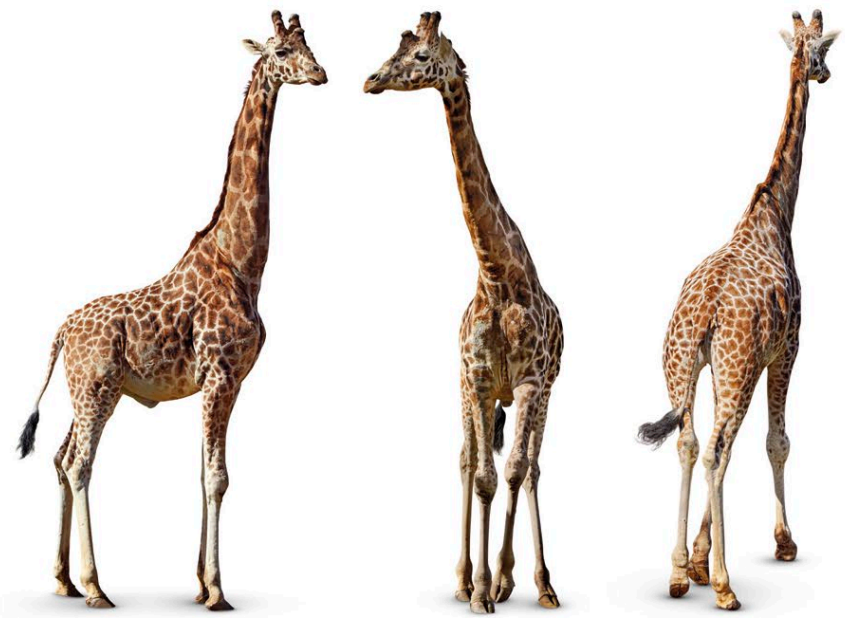


ROTHSCHILD'S GIRAFFE

Giraffa camelopardalis rothschildi

A subspecies of the northern giraffe, Rothschild's giraffes live in small, single-sex groups. Females often move from one group to another whereas adult males may be solitary. The sexes interact only to mate, the female producing a single calf after a gestation period of about 450 days. Calves are usually weaned at about 12 months. A giraffe's movement is restricted to walking and galloping — giraffes cannot trot or swim. When walking, the front and back legs on the same side move forward at the same time, and an adult can cover about 4.5 m (15 ft) in just one stride. When galloping away from predators, such as lions and African wild dogs, giraffes can reach speeds of up to 55 kph (34 mph).



SIZE 1.5–1.7 m (5–5½ ft)
HABITAT Open woodland, savanna grassland
DISTRIBUTION South Sudan, Kenya, and Uganda
DIET Leaves, shoots, seeds, and fruits of trees

the ossicones have a bald tip in adult males, but are covered with tufts of black hair in females

large, mobile ears keep giraffes alert to their surroundings

